



STATUS REPORT

Guinea-Bissau: status report

Edition of 2026-08-29 · 39 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-29 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/GNB/Ledger.csv](#) (39 systems and instruments, 1 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

SUMMARY OF POSITION · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · GAPS TO FILL

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Guinea-Bissau is assembling the basics of a digital state largely through donor-driven projects, on an infrastructure base that still lacks a national fibre backbone: international connectivity runs through a single 2023 submarine-cable landing ([ACE](#)) and, since June 2025, [Starlink](#), while the World Bank-financed [WARDIP-GB backbone](#) (a 2,877 km design) remains in development, its own governing final report not held. Two threads dominate the record: civil-registration and identity digitisation — SIREC's piloted registry digitisation, Semlex's 18-centre biometric-ID production network, and a field-issued ECOWAS biometric card (ENBIC) — and a 2025–26 governance and legislative build-out: a national data-governance and protection policy, a cybersecurity strategy, an interoperability regulation and a revised Electronic Communications Law, all approved by decree but none confirmed gazetted, alongside an [Enacted "digital integrity" law](#) against online falsehoods that the government has already invoked once. The country's first fully digital census ([RGPH4](#)) put the population at 2,191,202 in July 2026. Financing is substantial relative to the size of the base: a [US\\$60.5m World Bank IDA grant](#), a [US\\$25.4m MIGA guarantee behind Orange Bissau](#), and a [US\\$3.36m UNDP grant](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Digital Transformation Strategy 2025-2030 (ENTD.GW)	ENACTED, APPROVED BY DECREE 10/2025 ↗	Approved by Decreto n.o 10/2025 and published in the Boletim Oficial n.o 12, 4.o Suplemento, 28 March 2025

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Access to Information Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Final draft examined at a UNESCO-convened validation meeting, October 2024
ARN sector regulations (Decrees 14, 15 and 16 of 2010)	ENACTED ↗	Gazetted in the 2.o Suplemento to Boletim Oficial n.o 38, 22 September 2010
Digital Integrity (Dissemination of False Information on the Internet) Law	ENACTED ↗	CNT (transitional parliament) unanimously passed, with amendments, the Law on the Dissemination of False Information on the Internet - framed by spokesman Fernando Vaz as targeting those who spread hate and act against the State; enforcement mechanisms, including for citizens abroad, left unstated
Electronic Communications Law (revised)	UNDER REVIEW, COUNCIL OF MINISTERS APPROVED WITH AMENDMENTS ↗	Council of Ministers approved, with amendments, a proposed Electronic Communications Law replacing the outdated 2010 telecom regime, under the transitional presidency of Horta Inta-a; not confirmed passed by the CNT or published/in force
Electronic Transactions Bill 2025	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Put to public consultation by the ARN board under Aviso n.o 01/CA/ARN/2026, 8 May 2026
ICT Framework Law (Lei n.o 5/2010)	ENACTED ↗	Enacted by Lei n.o 5/2010 of 27 May 2010, Boletim Oficial n.o 21, 3.o Suplemento

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Data Governance and Protection Policy (decree)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Council of Ministers approved the draft decree (Política Nacional de Governança e Protecção de Dados) alongside decrees on interoperability and cybersecurity strategy; no confirmation on file of gazettal or entry into force

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AUDA-NEPAD Programme for African Developing Island Economies (Guinea-Bissau participation)	PLANNED ↗	AUDA-NEPAD launched the Programme for African Developing Island Economies at the STC-TTIM Ministerial Segment in Abidjan, covering Guinea-Bissau among seven states; ministers adopted a communique committing to a 2026-2031 roadmap with six pillars including digital transformation
CPLP digital rights charter	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed at São Tomé by all nine member states, 19 July 2024
ECOWAS Supplementary Act on Personal Data Protection (A/SA.1/01/10)	ENACTED ↗	Adopted by the ECOWAS Authority of Heads of State and Government, Abuja, 16 February 2010

Through 2025–26 the transitional state assembled a governance and legislative spine it had lacked: a [National Data Governance and Protection Policy](#) and a [National Cybersecurity Strategy](#), both approved by Council of Ministers decree in July 2025 alongside the interoperability regulation above, following a [January 2025 commitment](#) to create a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency that is not yet confirmed established. A [revised Electronic Communications Law](#), replacing the 2010 regime, was approved with amendments by Council of Ministers but not yet confirmed passed by the transitional parliament (CNT). The CNT did enact one digital law in the period: a ["Digital Integrity" law](#) against the dissemination of false information online, passed unanimously with amendments in May 2026 and [invoked for the first time in July 2026](#) against a false claim that TikTok would be shut down nationwide. Regionally, Guinea-Bissau was named among seven states in [AUDA-NEPAD's Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#), adopted at ministerial level in July 2026 with digital transformation as one of six pillars.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
MIGA guarantee - Sonatel/Orange Bissau S.A. equity investment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	MIGA approved a US\$25,435,357 guarantee (FY2025) to Sonatel SA covering its equity investment in Orange Bissau S.A., part of the combined Orange Guinea/Guinea-Bissau programme
UNDP Mais Digit@l for Guinea-Bissau grant	IMPLEMENTED ↗	UNDP committed a US\$3,360,500 grant (IATI OUTPUT 01004393) for a national digital-transformation programme implementing ENT.D.GW with UNU-EGOV technical assistance
World Bank WARDIP-GB (DTfA/WARDIP SOP1) IDA grant	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	WARDIP-GB programme launch ceremony presided by President Embalo in Bissau, marking the start of in-country implementation of the World Bank-financed grant

Guinea-Bissau's tracked development finance is concentrated in three instruments: a [US\\$60.5m World Bank IDA grant](#) (US\$60.00m grant plus US\$0.50m government counterpart) behind the WARDIP-GB programme, approved in November 2023 and in implementation since the April 2025 launch; a [US\\$25,435,357 MIGA guarantee](#), part of a combined Orange Guinea/Guinea-Bissau programme, covering Sonatel's equity investment in Orange Bissau; and a [US\\$3,360,500 UNDP grant](#) funding ENT.D.GW's implementation, of which US\$566,152 had been disbursed at the point captured.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
.GW country-code top-level domain	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Internationalised domain names supported from 2026-06-05
ACE (Africa Coast to Europe) submarine cable landing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Guinea-Bissau connects to its first international submarine fibre-optic cable (ACE)
Starlink satellite internet service	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Commercial launch
WARDIP-GB National Fibre-Optic Backbone	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	EIASS environmental and social safeguards study published, moving toward implementation
RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report (Apr 2025)	NOT HELD, SEARCHED 2026-08-27 - THE RNEP-GB FINAL REPORT IS HELD AND IS A DIFFERENT DOCUMENT	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency	PLANNED ↗	Government presented WARDIP/NRD Cyber Security feasibility study results and committed to create a National Cybersecurity and Data Protection Agency (Minister Marciano Silva Barbeiro), framed as central to digital sovereignty and data protection
National Cybersecurity Strategy (decree)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Council of Ministers approved the draft decree for a National Cybersecurity Strategy, following the January 2025 WARDIP/NRD Cyber Security feasibility study; no confirmation on file of gazettal or entry into force

Guinea-Bissau's international connectivity rests on a single submarine-cable landing — the ACE cable, live since March 2023 — supplemented since June 2025 by [Starlink's commercial satellite service](#), its 7th West African market. A national fibre backbone is still in development: the World Bank-financed [WARDIP-GB programme](#), launched in April 2025, has published a 2,877 km/56-node design and an environmental and social safeguards study, but the project's own governing Final Report is not held in the base, leaving the design specifics resting on an undated project-website primary.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ASYCUDAWorld customs management system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Went live across the customs estate, reported by UNCTAD 26 January 2026
eGIF-GW interoperability framework and platform	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Version 2.0 of the framework, platform and enterprise architecture delivered under WARDIP-GB, July 2024
Interoperability Regulation (public/private digital systems and platforms)	ENACTED, IN-FORCE DATE NOT HELD ↗	Government approval of the national interoperability regulation, announced 2026-08-08 by the WARDIP programme in Guinea-Bissau

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ENBIC (ECOWAS biometric ID) - Guinea-Bissau deployment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	262 women cross-border traders receive ENBIC cards in Sao Domingos (Cacheu) under a Guinea-Bissau-Senegal women-traders mobility pilot run by the National Borders Commission, ECOWAS-backed and GIZ-financed
PASSE automated border entry and exit control system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at Osvaldo Vieira International Airport, 22-23 January 2025
Semlex biometric national-ID production network	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Semlex opens a production centre in Safim (Biombo) - the third in Biombo, 100 cards per day - bringing the national network to 18 biometric-ID production centres; further centres planned for Sao Domingos and Bolama (Bijagos)

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Blockchain public wage-bill and pensions platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched May 2024 under the IMF Extended Credit Facility
KONTAKTU simplified tax and contribution payment system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Payment guidance issued by the Direcção-Geral das Contribuições e Impostos, 24 March 2021
Treasury Single Account (CUT) Regulation	ENACTED ↗	Regulation approved, announced by the Ministry of Economy and Finance 18 March 2025

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electoral register update and card replacement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Register handed to the elections commission 2026-08-18 for the 30 August referendum

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
SIREC (Integrated System of Citizen Registers and Statistics)	PILOTING ↗	Ministry of Justice Civil Registration Office (Raul Gomes) describes SIREC digitizing births, deaths and marriages, with UNDP-trained officers, roughly three months into rollout; birth registration remains below 50% (~46% of under-fives)
UNDP Building National ID project (civil-registry books scanning and digitization)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	UNDP project, co-financed by the Swiss Confederation, sets up a digitization centre and develops software to recover and digitize paper civil-registry books (births, deaths, marriages, annotations) as the country's main national identity platform

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
SIIC (Integrated Criminal Information System)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Reformulated centre inaugurated by the Minister of Justice, 9 March 2023

Civil-registration and identity digitisation is the most advanced thread: [SIREC](#), piloted since roughly March 2025, is digitising births, deaths and marriages with UNDP-trained officers, against a birth-registration rate for under-fives still around 46%; [Semlex's biometric national-ID production network](#) has grown to 18 centres nationwide, most recently a third Biombo centre at Safim; and the ECOWAS biometric card ([ENBIC](#)), already operationalised nationally, saw its first reported field issuance — 262 cards to women cross-border traders in São Domingos — in March 2026. A separate [UNDP project](#) is digitising the paper civil-registry books that underlie all of this. The country's first fully digital census, [RGPH4](#), released preliminary results in July 2026 putting the population at 2,191,202. An [interoperability regulation](#) for public and private digital systems was approved by Council of Ministers decree in July 2025 but its promulgation is not confirmed. Guinea-Bissau's electronic-money footprint remains thin regionally — [1.94% of UEMOA accounts opened, via just two issuing initiatives, though active accounts grew 33.28% in 2024](#).

Digitalisation

The base holds no digitalisation rows for Guinea-Bissau. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

The base holds no local-government or rural-digitalisation system for Guinea-Bissau. What is on record of service delivery outside the capital sits under DPI and Governance rather than under a digitalisation programme of its own.

Technology

The base holds no technology rows for Guinea-Bissau. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

No AI or technology-sector system is held on record for Guinea-Bissau.

Capacity

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
STARTOCODE digital-skills programme (Telecel + Government)	PILOTING ↗	Joint decree signed creating the STARTOCODE Coordination and Monitoring Committee, formalising programme implementation

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
RNEP-GB (National Research and Education Network)	PLANNED ↗	Proposed in the WARDIP-GB final report, July 2024

Capacity provision is thin and donor-shaped. [STARTOCODE](#), a digital-skills programme run jointly by Telecel and the government, is the only training instrument on record and is piloting under a coordination committee formalised by joint decree. On the research side there is a design and no build: the [RNEP-GB national research and education network](#) was specified under WARDIP-GB in July 2024 for 32 higher-education institutions and membership of WACREN, in a three-phase roadmap from legal establishment to national reach, and nothing on file records it being established.

Inclusion

The base holds no inclusion rows for Guinea-Bissau. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

Guinea-Bissau's only tracked skills programme is [STARTOCODE](#), a Telecel-government partnership whose coordination committee was formalised by joint decree in May 2026, targeting 1,000 youth trained annually over four years in programming, data analysis and cloud computing. [Internet penetration stood at 32.5%](#) in the last measurement held (January 2025), with no fresher survey on file.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
IMF e-GDDS National Summary Data Page	IMPLEMENTED ↗	National Summary Data Page launched, announced by the IMF 8 July 2024
National Statistical System Framework Law (Lei n.o 6/2007)	ENACTED ↗	Enacted by Lei n.o 6/2007 of 10 September 2007
RGPH4 (4th General Population and Housing Census)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	INE releases RGPH4 preliminary results - population 2,191,202 (up from 1,449,230 in 2009), the country's first fully digital (CAPI) census, financed by UNFPA (lead technical agency) and the World Bank

Statistics is the one part of the record where the institutional base is complete rather than partial. The national statistical system has rested on [Lei n.o 6/2007](#) since 2007, as amended by two 2023 decrees; the INE has published essential macroeconomic data on an [IMF e-GDDS National Summary Data Page](#) since July 2024; and [RGPH4](#), the country's first fully digital census, released preliminary results in July 2026 putting the population at 2,191,202.

Geopolitics

The base holds no geopolitics rows for Guinea-Bissau. A thin evidence base is a finding, not a gap in this document.

The base holds no geopolitical instrument for Guinea-Bissau. Its external digital relationships appear on this record as financing and as regional membership, and are carried under Finance and under Governance rather than here.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report (Apr 2025)	The RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report itself, which would date and confirm the backbone design specifics (2,877 km, 56 nodes) currently resting on an undated project-website primary.	not yet probed

The one dated absence on record is the RNEP-GB / WARDIP-GB Final Report, which would confirm the backbone's design specifics — currently resting on an undated project-website primary — and is not held as of 20 July 2026.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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